Okoye Laboratory: Quarterly Report, January to March 2026

Summary

Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. The compost came from three sites, and each site was sampled at 9 points along a transect. Priya prepared 12 replicates of malt extract agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. Sven prepared 14 replicates of corn meal agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on potato dextrose broth.

The forest soil was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction. Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids. The root washings was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction. Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 55 s, and spun at 5228 g for 12 minutes. All media were autoclaved and poured in G.10, and the plates were dried for 44 minutes in the cabinet.

Sven prepared 6 replicates of Czapek agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. The beech litter came from three sites, and each site was sampled at 9 points along a transect. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range. The peat came from three sites, and each site was sampled at 4 points along a transect.

A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on malt extract agar. Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range.

Finance

Consumables spending in the first quarter was £15,880.20, which is 3% over budget, chiefly because of the extra agar bought in January.

Training on the new plate reader is arranged for the first week of the month; Tom will run it. The booking sheet for the balance in G.14 was reorganised so that overnight runs are marked clearly. The shared fridge in the cold room was cleared out, and anything unlabelled was thrown away. The cold room in G.16 will be defrosted over the weekend, so nothing should be left on the floor shelves.

Priya will cover the weekend checks of the plate reader until the end of the month. Hana will cover the weekend checks of Incubator B until the end of the month. Visitors to the cold room must sign the book and be accompanied at all times.

Sven will order the malt extract agar and the pipette tips for next month, and asked everyone to put

requests in the sheet by Friday. Dr. Okoye reminded the group that waste from G.12 goes into the yellow bins and sharps into the rigid containers. The cold room in the prep room will be defrosted over the weekend, so nothing should be left on the floor shelves. The shared fridge in the cold room was cleared out, and anything unlabelled was thrown away. The shared fridge in G.14 was cleared out, and anything unlabelled was thrown away.

Research progress

Plates were incubated at 28 °C for 96 h before counting, and each count was made by two people. The pellet was resuspended in 204 µL of sterile water and transferred to a clean tube. Plates were incubated at 37 °C for 48 h before counting, and each count was made by two people.

Incubator A was checked before the run and showed no drift against the reference. The pellet was resuspended in 277 µL of sterile water and transferred to a clean tube. Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. The pellet was resuspended in 181 µL of sterile water and transferred to a clean tube. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range.

Imani prepared 23 replicates of malt extract agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on malt extract agar. Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. The pellet was resuspended in 171 µL of sterile water and transferred to a clean tube.

Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 25 s, and spun at 4731 g for 14 minutes. Plates were incubated at 30 °C for 48 h before counting, and each count was made by two people. A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on potato dextrose broth. All media were autoclaved and poured in G.16, and the plates were dried for 31 minutes in the cabinet. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range.

The beech litter came from three sites, and each site was sampled at 7 points along a transect. Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 58 s, and spun at 6701 g for 6 minutes. All media were autoclaved and poured in G.14, and the plates were dried for 18 minutes in the cabinet.

Plans

The department asked for the equipment inventory to be updated; Priya has the spreadsheet. The booking sheet for Incubator B was reorganised so that overnight runs are marked clearly. A reminder that all new strains need an accession number from Tom before they go into the freezer.

A reminder that all new strains need an accession number from Hana before they go into the freezer. Dr. Okoye reminded the group that waste from G.12 goes into the yellow bins and sharps into the rigid containers. Hana will order the corn meal agar and the pipette tips for next month, and asked everyone to put requests in the sheet by Friday. Visitors to the prep room must sign the book and be accompanied at all times.

The booking sheet for the plate reader was reorganised so that overnight runs are marked clearly. Tom will cover the weekend checks of the autoclave until the end of the month. The booking sheet for the plate reader was reorganised so that overnight runs are marked clearly. A reminder that all new strains need an accession number from Imani before they go into the freezer.